

Refining Images for Printing: There may have been vast technological advances in monitors, but the best way to admire a photograph is still the good old fashioned photo print. After all, it's only a print that you can frame and place by your bedside—and you definitely can't carry a jpeg file around in your wallet. For a picture that means so much to you that you want it in print form, you need to make sure it's done with the utmost care.

To get the best quality from your print you need to use at least a 300 dpi image. Just the way a digital image is composed of and measured in pixels, a print is measured in dpi (dots per inch). The lower the dpi, the more graininess you'll notice in your print. 300 dpi is considered the industry standard for a good quality print. But chances are that your camera may not shoot at exactly that dpi, so you'll need to address that in a simple Photoshop exercise.

- Open the image you wish to print in Photoshop
- From the toolbar, go to Image > Image Size to get the 'Image Size' window to open
- At the bottom of the pop-up window there will be a checkbox that says 'Resample Image'. Take the checkmark off that box
- Now in the Resolution box, change the number to 300
- Click the OK button to close the box

You may not notice a difference in the image quality after doing this, but your printer definitely will. You can select the page layout in the printer driver options, along with the size you want to print.

Optimising Pictures For The Internet

Bigger may be better when you want to view your photos with all the intricate details at home. But if you want to share the picture on your Web site or e-mail it to your friends and family, then you have to consider the bandwidth limitations that come up. Sending a one-megabyte image file over the Net is not only time consuming, it also blocks the receiver's bandwidth during the transfer process. You may even end up blocking someone's e-mail inbox with your last trip's photo album. If you have anything over a one-megapixel camera, make sure you optimise the photos before posting them on the Net or sending it to other people. Here are a few Photoshop steps that show you how.